



While water helps the rice to grow, it kills off weeds that can't grow in such watery conditions.

Rice is a type of grass.

Most rice is grown in flooded fields called paddies.

The fields are flooded for most of the growing season.

The rice is planted in straight lines.



Harvesting

The rice is ready for harvesting in three to six months. The fields are drained and the plants cut down, tied in bundles, and left to dry.



Winnowing

The rice is beaten to remove the grains. The grains are crushed and then sieved and tossed to remove any fine pieces of husk.



Machine power

In the US, growing rice is highly mechanized. Tractors prepare the fields, the seed may be sown from airplanes, and combine harvesters gather the ripe plants.



Safekeeping

Special buildings are used to store the rice until it is needed. They are called granaries. A granary keeps the grain dry and safe from hungry animals.

All rice



Puffed rice cakes



Rice noodles



Sticky rice cakes



Rice paper

